



FROM THE FIELD TO THE FORTUNE

FROM THE FIELD TO THE FORTUNE

The College Football History Board Game

"Football is to the South what religion is to the soul"

1890s

1920s

1940s

1960s

1970s

1990s

2010s

TODAY

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INTRODUCTION / WELCOME

You have been invited to play **FROM THE FIELD TO THE FORTUNE** on behalf of your company's leadership team. As an executive of a Fortune 100 firm exploring opportunities in the billion-dollar industry of American college football, you may be wondering: why does college football matter so much in the United States, and specifically in the American South?

This game was designed to answer exactly that question.

Unlike professional sports, college football in America is not just a business — it is a **cultural institution**. It has shaped the identity of entire regions, reflected the racial and social struggles of a nation, survived two World Wars, and grown from humble 1890s scrimmages into a multi-billion dollar media empire. Understanding its history is essential to understanding the opportunity your firm is evaluating.

As you play, you will not just be buying programs and collecting revenue. You will travel through more than **130 years of American history** — from the first Southern football games in the 1890s, through the painful but transformative era of racial integration, through World War II, the Civil Rights Movement, and into the modern controversies of NIL deals, the transfer portal, and conference realignment. Every card you draw, every program you acquire, and every event you encounter is grounded in real history.

By the time the game ends, you will understand not only **why college football is worth billions of dollars** — but why it matters to the people who love it.

Welcome to the game. Welcome to the South.

GAME OVERVIEW

FROM THE FIELD TO THE FORTUNE is a property-acquisition game about building a college football empire. Players begin as program commissioners in the **1890s** with modest resources and work to acquire, develop, and profit from college football programs across eight historical eras of American history.

Players buy programs, collect program revenue from opponents, build **Recruiting Classes** and **Stadium Expansions** to increase their earnings, and navigate the turbulent events of American history — from World War II drafts to the Civil Rights Movement to the modern NIL era.

The wealthiest commissioner standing at the end of the game wins.

THE SEVEN THEMES OF COLLEGE FOOTBALL HISTORY

This game is built around **seven essential themes**. Each is woven into the board, the cards, and the program groups you will encounter during play. Read these before you begin — they will give you the context you need to understand what is happening as you play.

THEME 1: The Growth of College Football in the South

College football in the American South began in the early 1890s, decades after the game first appeared in the Northeast. Southern universities like Auburn, Vanderbilt, and Georgia quickly adopted the sport, and it soon took on a significance that went far beyond athletics. In a region still recovering from the Civil War and searching for identity, football became a source of pride, community, and regional rivalry. By the mid-20th century, the South was the undisputed heartland of college football culture.

THEME 2: Eight Reasons College Football Is Different in the South

College football in the South is unlike anywhere else. Here are eight reasons why:

- **IDENTITY** — In Southern states, the university team IS the regional identity. People who never attended a school will still bleed its colors for life.
- **NO PRO COMPETITION** — For decades, the South had no NFL franchises. The college game was the only game in town — and it filled that void completely.
- **SMALL TOWN ECONOMIES** — Schools like Auburn, Alabama, and Clemson are located in small towns. On game day, the stadium is one of the largest gatherings of people in the entire state.
- **RELIGIOUS DEVOTION** — The culture around Southern football resembles religious practice — Saturday rituals, sacred stadiums, legendary coaches treated like prophets, and devotion passed down through generations.
- **COACHING CULTURE** — Legendary coaches like Bear Bryant (Alabama), Vince Dooley (Georgia), and Bobby Bowden (Florida State) became cultural icons, not just sports figures.
- **INTEGRATION AS A FLASHPOINT** — The integration of Southern college football teams was among the most public and contested civil rights battles in the region's history.
- **SEC DOMINANCE** — The SEC has won more national championships than any other conference and is widely considered the most competitive — and most lucrative — conference in college football.
- **THE STADIUM EXPERIENCE** — Southern stadiums like Bryant-Denny (Alabama), Tiger Stadium (LSU), and Death Valley (Clemson) are among the largest sporting venues in the world.

THEME 3: The Integration of College Football

For decades, Southern college football was racially segregated. Black athletes were barred from playing at major Southern universities. The integration of college football was slow, painful, and contested. It accelerated after a famous 1970 game in which USC's integrated team defeated all-white Alabama — an event that reportedly convinced Bear Bryant to begin recruiting Black players. By the mid-1970s, most Southern programs were integrated. The influx of Black talent transformed the game and the culture around it permanently.

THEME 4: The Billion-Dollar Industry

College football today generates over **\$8 billion annually**. Television contracts alone — most notably the SEC's deals with ESPN and CBS — are worth hundreds of millions of dollars per year. The College Football Playoff (CFP) distributes billions in revenue to conferences. Head coaches earn \$8–10 million per year. Stadiums seat 80,000–107,000 fans. This is one of the most lucrative sports enterprises in the world — and it is built entirely on the labor of unpaid (until very recently) college students.

THEME 5: The Racial Context of College Football

Race and college football have been intertwined since the beginning. Before integration, Black colleges and universities (HBCUs) developed their own football tradition — one that produced brilliant players who were invisible to the mainstream white programs. After integration, Black athletes became the backbone of the sport's greatest teams, yet the coaching ranks and athletic department leadership remained overwhelmingly white. Today, the majority of players at top programs are Black, while most head coaches and administrators are white — a disparity that continues to generate debate.

THEME 6: Broader Social Events That Shaped the Game

College football did not exist in a vacuum. The Great Depression forced programs to cut budgets. World War II canceled entire seasons and sent thousands of players to combat. The Civil Rights Movement forced universities to confront segregation through the football field. The Cold War, Vietnam protests on campuses, and the social upheaval of the 1960s all left their marks on the game.

THEME 7: Current Issues Facing College Football

College football is in the middle of its most disruptive era since integration:

- **NIL (Name, Image & Likeness):** Since 2021, college athletes can earn money from endorsements, appearances, and social media. A star quarterback might earn millions before ever playing a professional game.
- **The Transfer Portal:** Players can now transfer to any school without sitting out a year. This has created a free-agent marketplace and fundamentally changed how rosters are built each season.
- **Revenue Share:** As of 2025, schools are beginning to share direct revenue with athletes — a seismic shift from the 'amateur' model that defined college sports for over a century.
- **Conference Realignment:** Traditional geographic conferences have been shattered by billion-dollar TV deals. USC and UCLA left the Pac-12 for the Big Ten. Texas and Oklahoma left for the SEC. The map of college football is being redrawn by money, not tradition.

OBJECT OF THE GAME

To be the **only Commissioner left in the game who has not gone bankrupt**. The last Commissioner standing — with the most valuable college football empire — is declared the winner.

EQUIPMENT

- 1 Digital game board (40 spaces, viewed on mobile device or shared screen)
- 28 Program Deed cards (one per acquirable program)
- 16 Gridiron Events cards (replaces Chance)
- 16 Commissioner's Office cards (replaces Community Chest)
- 1 set of Gridiron Dollars (digital currency, tracked in-game)
- 32 Recruiting Class tokens (replaces Houses)
- 12 Stadium Expansion tokens (replaces Hotels)
- 2 digital dice
- 2–5 player tokens (football helmet icons, each a different color)
- 4 Bowl Game cards (replaces Railroads)
- 2 TV Contract cards (replaces Utilities)

SETUP

1. Each player selects a team helmet token and places it on **KICKOFF (GO)**.
2. The game engine automatically distributes **\$3 BILLION in Gridiron Dollars** to each player at the start of the game.
3. The **game engine** acts as Commissioner and manages all banking functions automatically — distributing Gridiron Dollars, handling auctions, and managing Program Deeds, Recruiting Class tokens, and Stadium Expansion tokens.
4. Shuffle the **Gridiron Events** cards and **Commissioner's Office** cards separately. Place each deck face-down in their designated board spaces.
5. Players roll both dice. The player with the highest roll goes first. Play passes to the left.

Note: The Commissioner's bank never goes bankrupt. If Gridiron Dollars run low, IOUs written on paper are acceptable.

BOARD EXPLANATION — SPACE GUIDE

The board is divided into **40 spaces** traveled clockwise. Below is a summary of every space type you will encounter.

CORNER SPACES

■ KICKOFF (GO)

Collect **\$2M** in Gridiron Dollars each time you land on or pass this space. This represents the annual salary and stipend paid to commissioners.

■ NCAA PROBATION (Jail / Just Visiting)

If you are sent here, you are under investigation. See Section 11 for rules. If you were not sent here, you are 'Just Visiting' — no penalty applies.

■ NIL SIGNING DAY (Free Parking)

You rest here until your next turn. No penalty. You may conduct business as usual. Think of it as the quiet moment before the chaos of the transfer portal opens.

■ GO TO COMMISSIONER'S OFFICE (Go to Jail)

Move directly to NCAA Probation. Do not pass Kickoff. Do not collect \$2M.

PROGRAM SPACES (28 Total)

These are the acquirable football programs, grouped by historical era (color group). Each era group contains 2–3 programs. Owning all programs within an era group gives you a **CONFERENCE MONOPOLY** and doubles the revenue you collect from opponents who land there (before any buildings are added).

COLOR	ERA GROUP	PROGRAMS	PRICE RANGE
Brown	The Founding Era (1890s–1900s)	Auburn Tigers, Vanderbilt Commodores	\$60M–\$100M
Light Blue	The Early Growth Era (1910s–1920s)	Georgia Tech, Tennessee, Georgia (E)	\$100M–\$120M
Pink	Depression & Wartime Era (1930s–1940s)	LSU Tigers, Ole Miss, Mississippi State	\$140M–\$160M
Orange	Integration Era (1950s–1960s)	Florida Gators, South Carolina, Kentucky	\$180M–\$200M
Red	The Bear Bryant Era (1960s–1970s)	Alabama (E), Arkansas, Texas Longhorns	\$220M–\$240M
Yellow	Conference Expansion Era (1980s–1990s)	Florida State, Miami, Notre Dame	\$260M–\$280M
Green	The BCS/Playoff Era (2000s–2010s)	Ohio State, USC Trojans, Clemson	\$300M–\$320M
Dark Blue	The NIL/Modern Era (2010s–Present)	Georgia (Modern), Alabama (Modern)	\$350M–\$400M

OTHER BOARD SPACES

■ BOWL GAME SPACES (4 total)

Rose Bowl, Sugar Bowl, Orange Bowl, Cotton Bowl. Each costs \$200M. Revenue scales with number owned. May be mortgaged but not built upon.

■ TV CONTRACT SPACES (2 total)

ESPN Contract, CBS/SEC Network Contract. Each costs \$150M. Revenue is based on opponent's dice roll × a multiplier.

■ GRIDIRON EVENTS (3 spaces)

Draw from the Gridiron Events deck. Follow instructions immediately. Return card to bottom of deck.

■ COMMISSIONER'S OFFICE (3 spaces)

Draw from the Commissioner's Office deck. Follow instructions immediately. Return card to bottom of deck.

■ **PROGRAM EXPENSES (Income Tax)**

Pay \$200K or 10% of total assets, whichever is LESS. Decide before calculating.

■ **STADIUM RENOVATION TAX (Luxury Tax)**

Pay \$100K to the Commissioner.

GAMEPLAY RULES

On your turn, roll both dice and move your token **clockwise** around the board the number of spaces shown. The space you land on determines what happens.

Depending on where you land, you may:

- Acquire an unowned Program, Bowl Game, or TV Contract
- Pay program revenue to the owner of the space you landed on
- Pay taxes
- Draw a Gridiron Events or Commissioner's Office card
- Go to NCAA Probation
- Rest on NIL Signing Day (Free Parking)
- Collect \$2M by passing or landing on Kickoff (GO)
- Be 'Just Visiting' at NCAA Probation

Two or more tokens may rest on the same space simultaneously.

SPECIAL RULES

DOUBLES

If you roll doubles, take your turn as normal, then **roll again** for a bonus turn. If you roll doubles a **third time in a row**, go directly to NCAA Probation.

PASSING KICKOFF (GO)

Every time you pass or land on KICKOFF, collect **\$2M** from the Commissioner. You may collect \$2M twice in one turn if a card sends you forward past Kickoff. However, you do **NOT** collect \$2M when sent to NCAA Probation, or when sent backward by a card.

ACQUIRING ASSETS

When you land on an **unowned Program space**, you have the **FIRST RIGHT** to buy it from the Commissioner at the printed price. Pay the Commissioner and receive that Program's Deed card, which you keep face-up in front of you as proof of ownership.

AUCTION RULE: If you decline to buy, the Commissioner immediately AUCTIONS the program to the highest bidder, starting at any price another player is willing to pay. Even if you declined the purchase, you may participate in the auction. The same rules apply to Bowl Games and TV Contracts.

BOWL GAMES (Replaces Railroads)

Bowl Games represent the postseason revenue opportunities that fuel college football's billion-dollar economy.

BOWL GAMES OWNED	REVENUE COLLECTED
Own 1 Bowl Game	\$25M
Own 2 Bowl Games	\$50M
Own 3 Bowl Games	\$100M
Own 4 Bowl Games	\$200M

★ HISTORICAL NOTE

Bowl games were originally corporate sponsorship events designed to promote tourism and local economies. The Sugar Bowl (New Orleans), Cotton Bowl (Dallas), Orange Bowl (Miami), and Rose Bowl (Pasadena) became among the most prestigious events in college sports. Today, the College Football Playoff has largely replaced the bowl system as the marquee postseason event.

TV CONTRACTS (Replaces Utilities)

Television contracts are the engine of college football's financial empire.

TV CONTRACTS OWNED	REVENUE FROM OPPONENT
Own 1 TV Contract	4× opponent's dice roll (in \$M)
Own both TV Contracts	10× opponent's dice roll (in \$M)

★ HISTORICAL NOTE

ESPN's \$7.3 billion deal with the SEC (signed 2023, running through 2034) is the most valuable media rights deal in college sports history. Before this era, major college programs earned a fraction of what they earn today. Television transformed college football from a regional pastime into a national industry.

REVENUE & MONOPOLY MECHANICS

When you land on a Program space owned by another player, you must pay that player the revenue shown on their Deed card. The owner **MUST** ask for revenue before the next player rolls the dice. If the owner fails to ask in time, they **forfeit the revenue** for that visit.

CONFERENCE MONOPOLY (Color Group Complete)

If a player owns ALL programs within an era group (color group), the revenue on any **unbuilt** program in that group is **DOUBLED**. This represents the compounding advantage of owning a complete conference.

Exception: Double revenue is NOT collected if any program in the group is currently mortgaged. Revenue is never collected on mortgaged programs.

NCAA PROBATION (Jail Rules)

You are sent to NCAA Probation if:

- You land on the GO TO COMMISSIONER'S OFFICE space
- A Gridiron Events or Commissioner's Office card sends you there
- You roll doubles three times in a row

While under Probation, you CAN still collect program revenue from opponents who land on your properties.

To get out of Probation, you may:

- Pay a fine of **\$50K** and move on your next turn
- Use an 'Escape NCAA Investigation' card (if you have one)
- Purchase an 'Escape NCAA Investigation' card from another player at a mutually agreed price
- Wait up to three turns, rolling the dice each turn trying to roll doubles. If you roll doubles, move out using that roll.
- After three failed turns, you **MUST** pay \$50K and move on the next turn.

★ HISTORICAL NOTE

NCAA Probation is a real and serious penalty. Programs placed on probation may face scholarship reductions, bowl bans, recruiting restrictions, and public humiliation. Southern Methodist University (SMU) received the 'death penalty' in 1987 — a complete suspension of their football program for violations so severe the NCAA effectively shut them down.

BUILDING SYSTEM — RECRUITING CLASSES & STADIUMS

RECRUITING CLASSES (Replaces Houses)

Once you own all programs in an era group (Conference Monopoly), you may begin adding **RECRUITING CLASSES** to your programs. Recruiting Classes represent the investment in talent that drives program revenue — the better your class, the more valuable your program becomes.

Building Rules:

- You may build Recruiting Classes on your turn or between other players' turns.
- You must build **EVENLY**: you cannot build a second Recruiting Class on any one program until every program in the group has at least one.
- Maximum of **4 Recruiting Classes** per program (before a Stadium Expansion).
- You may NOT build if any program in the color group is mortgaged.
- Costs are shown on each Program Deed card.

Selling Recruiting Classes:

- Sell back to the Commissioner at **HALF** the purchase price.
- Must also be sold evenly (sell one from each program in the group before selling a second from any one program).

★ HISTORICAL NOTE

The annual recruiting cycle is one of the most intense and scrutinized events in college football. National Signing Day — when high school players officially commit to programs — is treated as a major media event. The emergence of the transfer portal has added a second annual 'recruiting' cycle for experienced players.

STADIUM EXPANSIONS (Replaces Hotels)

A **STADIUM EXPANSION** is the highest level of program development. It replaces 4 Recruiting Classes and dramatically increases the revenue your program generates.

Building Rules:

- You must have **4 Recruiting Classes** on EACH program in the color group before building a Stadium Expansion on any one of them.
- When you build a Stadium Expansion, return the 4 Recruiting Classes to the Commissioner and pay the additional cost shown on the Deed.
- Only **ONE** Stadium Expansion may be built per program.

★ HISTORICAL NOTE

The stadiums of the American South are among the largest in the world. Bryant-Denny Stadium (Alabama) seats 101,821. Tiger Stadium (LSU) seats 102,321. Neyland Stadium (Tennessee) seats 101,915. These are not just sports venues — they are economic engines for their surrounding communities, generating hundreds of millions of dollars per season in local spending.

PROGRAM DEED REVENUE TABLES

Each Program Deed card shows the program's purchase price, building costs, and revenue scale. All values are in **MILLIONS of Gridiron Dollars (\$M)**.

Rcrt1–Rcrt4 = revenue with 1–4 Recruiting Classes. Stadium = revenue with Stadium Expansion. Bldg\$ = cost per Recruiting Class (and Stadium Expansion cost).

FOUNDING ERA (Brown)

Program	Price	Rcrt1	Rcrt2	Rcrt3	Rcrt4	Stadium	Bldg\$
Auburn Tigers	\$60M	\$2M	\$10M	\$30M	\$90M	\$160M	\$50M
Vanderbilt Commodores	\$100M	\$4M	\$20M	\$60M	\$180M	\$320M	\$50M

EARLY GROWTH ERA (Light Blue)

Program	Price	Rcrt1	Rcrt2	Rcrt3	Rcrt4	Stadium	Bldg\$
Georgia Tech	\$100M	\$6M	\$30M	\$90M	\$270M	\$450M	\$50M
Tennessee Volunteers	\$120M	\$8M	\$40M	\$100M	\$300M	\$500M	\$50M
Georgia Bulldogs (E)	\$120M	\$8M	\$40M	\$100M	\$300M	\$500M	\$50M

DEPRESSION & WARTIME ERA (Pink)

Program	Price	Rcrt1	Rcrt2	Rcrt3	Rcrt4	Stadium	Bldg\$
LSU Tigers	\$140M	\$10M	\$50M	\$150M	\$450M	\$750M	\$100M
Ole Miss Rebels	\$140M	\$10M	\$50M	\$150M	\$450M	\$750M	\$100M
Mississippi State	\$160M	\$12M	\$60M	\$180M	\$500M	\$900M	\$100M

INTEGRATION ERA (Orange)

Program	Price	Rcrt1	Rcrt2	Rcrt3	Rcrt4	Stadium	Bldg\$
Florida Gators	\$180M	\$14M	\$70M	\$200M	\$550M	\$950M	\$100M
South Carolina	\$180M	\$14M	\$70M	\$200M	\$550M	\$950M	\$100M
Kentucky Wildcats	\$200M	\$16M	\$80M	\$220M	\$600M	\$1,000M	\$100M

BEAR BRYANT ERA (Red)

Program	Price	Rcrt1	Rcrt2	Rcrt3	Rcrt4	Stadium	Bldg\$
Alabama (Early)	\$220M	\$18M	\$90M	\$250M	\$700M	\$1,050M	\$150M
Arkansas Razorbacks	\$220M	\$18M	\$90M	\$250M	\$700M	\$1,050M	\$150M
Texas Longhorns	\$240M	\$20M	\$100M	\$300M	\$750M	\$1,100M	\$150M

CONFERENCE EXPANSION ERA (Yellow)

Program	Price	Rcrt1	Rcrt2	Rcrt3	Rcrt4	Stadium	Bldg\$
Florida State	\$260M	\$22M	\$110M	\$330M	\$800M	\$1,150M	\$150M
Miami Hurricanes	\$260M	\$22M	\$110M	\$330M	\$800M	\$1,150M	\$150M
Notre Dame	\$280M	\$24M	\$120M	\$360M	\$850M	\$1,200M	\$150M

BCS/PLAYOFF ERA (Green)

Program	Price	Rcrt1	Rcrt2	Rcrt3	Rcrt4	Stadium	Bldg\$
Ohio State Buckeyes	\$300M	\$26M	\$130M	\$390M	\$900M	\$1,275M	\$200M
USC Trojans	\$300M	\$26M	\$130M	\$390M	\$900M	\$1,275M	\$200M
Clemson Tigers	\$320M	\$28M	\$140M	\$400M	\$950M	\$1,300M	\$200M

NIL/MODERN ERA (Dark Blue)

Program	Price	Rcrt1	Rcrt2	Rcrt3	Rcrt4	Stadium	Bldg\$
Georgia (Modern)	\$350M	\$35M	\$175M	\$500M	\$1,100M	\$1,500M	\$200M
Alabama (Modern)	\$400M	\$50M	\$200M	\$600M	\$1,400M	\$2,000M	\$200M

GRIDIRON EVENTS CARDS

When you land on a **GRIDIRON EVENTS** space, draw the top card from the deck, follow its instructions immediately, then return it to the bottom of the deck. If you draw an 'Escape NCAA Investigation' card, keep it until you choose to use or sell it.

"ADVANCE TO KICKOFF"

Move directly to Kickoff (GO). Collect \$2M.

[Theme: GO mechanic — program revenue / commissioner salary]

"WORLD WAR II DRAFT — YOUR SEASON IS CANCELED"

Lose your next turn. Your players have been drafted. Historically, many programs canceled full seasons in 1943–1945. Over 1,000 college football players died in WWII.

[Theme: Broader Social Events — WWII]

"ESPN SIGNS A LANDMARK DEAL"

Advance to the nearest TV Contract space. If unowned, buy it. If owned, pay double the standard revenue to the owner.

[Theme: Billion-Dollar Industry — TV Contracts]

"BEAR BRYANT INTEGRATES ALABAMA"

Collect \$500K from the Commissioner. Your program's integration brings elite Black talent and elevates your program's prestige. (Inspired by Alabama's integration following the 1970 loss to USC.)

[Theme: Integration of College Football]

"CONFERENCE REALIGNMENT — ADVANCE TO NEAREST BOWL GAME"

Move to the nearest Bowl Game space. If unowned, buy it. If owned, pay revenue to the owner.

[Theme: Current Issues — Conference Realignment]

"YOUR STAR PLAYER ENTERS THE TRANSFER PORTAL"

Pay \$150K to the Commissioner. Your best recruit has announced his transfer. The program takes a hit.

[Theme: Current Issues — Transfer Portal]

"GO DIRECTLY TO NCAA PROBATION"

Do not pass Kickoff. Do not collect \$2M.

[Theme: Current Issues — NCAA oversight and violations]

"NIL DEAL — COLLECT \$200K"

Your program's star athlete lands a major endorsement deal, generating publicity and revenue for your brand. Collect \$200K from the Commissioner.

[Theme: Current Issues — NIL]

"ADVANCE TO AUBURN TIGERS"

Move to the Auburn Tigers space. If unowned, buy it. If owned, pay revenue. If you pass Kickoff, collect \$2M.

[Theme: Growth of CFB in the South — Founding Era programs]

"THE CIVIL RIGHTS MOVEMENT COMES TO YOUR CAMPUS"

Pay \$100K in administrative costs OR integrate your roster: remove one Recruiting Class token from any of your programs but gain a \$300K revenue bonus added to that program's base revenue for the rest of the game.

[Theme: Integration / Racial Context / Social Events]

"YOUR PROGRAM IS FINED FOR RECRUITING VIOLATIONS"

Pay \$15K per Recruiting Class you currently own across all programs.

[Theme: Current Issues — NCAA compliance]

"REVENUE SHARING VOTE — COLLECT FROM ALL PLAYERS"

The new revenue-sharing model passes. Collect \$100K from every other player. (If a player cannot pay, they pay what they can.)

[Theme: Current Issues — Revenue Share]

"ADVANCE TO ILLINOIS (GO BACK THREE SPACES)"

Move back three spaces. Act on whatever space you land on.

[Theme: General gameplay event]

"ESCAPE NCAA INVESTIGATION"

Keep this card until you need it. Use it to leave NCAA Probation without paying a fine, or sell it to another player at any agreed price.

[Theme: Current Issues — NCAA violations and legal battles]

"YOUR STADIUM SELLS OUT FOR THE SEASON"

Collect \$50K from every other player. The electricity of a sold-out Southern stadium is unlike anything in American sports.

[Theme: Billion-Dollar Industry / CFB different in South]

"YOU MADE THE COLLEGE FOOTBALL PLAYOFF"

Collect \$300K from the Commissioner. The CFP distributes over \$500 million to conferences annually. You earned your share.

[Theme: Billion-Dollar Industry — CFP revenue]

COMMISSIONER'S OFFICE CARDS

When you land on a **COMMISSIONER'S OFFICE** space, draw the top card, follow its instructions immediately, and return it to the bottom of the deck.

"BANK ERROR IN YOUR FAVOR — COLLECT \$200K"

The NCAA's accounting department made an error. Collect \$200K from the Commissioner.

[Theme: Billion-Dollar Industry — NCAA finances]

"PAY HOSPITAL BILL FOR INJURED PLAYER — PAY \$100K"

A key player suffers an injury. College athletes were not traditionally compensated for injuries — this cost falls to your program.

[Theme: Racial Context — player welfare and exploitation debate]

"ADVANCE TO KICKOFF (GO) — COLLECT \$2M"

Move directly to Kickoff and collect \$2M.

[Theme: GO mechanic]

"YOU ARE ELECTED CONFERENCE COMMISSIONER"

Collect \$100K from each player. Conference commissioners are among the highest-paid executives in sports, with SEC Commissioner Greg Sankey earning over \$4 million annually.

[Theme: Billion-Dollar Industry]

"HBCU FOOTBALL PIONEERED THIS GAME — EDUCATIONAL BONUS"

Collect \$150K from the Commissioner. HBCUs maintained thriving football programs when Black players were barred from white universities. Figures like Eddie Robinson (Grambling State, 408 wins) were giants of the game long before integration.

[Theme: Racial Context — HBCU football tradition]

"TITLE IX COMPLIANCE — PAY \$75K"

Your program must fund equivalent athletic opportunities for women. The 1972 Title IX legislation forced universities to expand women's sports programs, reshaping athletic department budgets permanently.

[Theme: Broader Social Events — legislative changes]

"YOUR HEAD COACH LEAVES FOR THE NFL — LOSE ONE RECRUITING CLASS"

A rival NFL team has poached your coach. Remove one Recruiting Class token from any one of your programs. Return it to the Commissioner.

[Theme: General gameplay / coaching culture]

"THE GREAT DEPRESSION — PAY \$10K PER PROGRAM YOU OWN"

The economic collapse of the 1930s hit college athletic budgets hard. Multiple programs nearly folded. Pay \$10K for each program deed you hold.

[Theme: Broader Social Events — Great Depression]

"GO TO NCAA PROBATION"

Move directly to NCAA Probation. Do not pass Kickoff. Do not collect \$2M.

[Theme: NCAA violations]

"COLLECT \$25K FROM EVERY PLAYER — BOWL GAME PAYOUT"

Your conference negotiated a strong bowl payout. Collect \$25K from every other player.

[Theme: Billion-Dollar Industry — bowl revenue]

"DESEGREGATION ORDER — HISTORICAL MOMENT"

Read aloud: "In 1963, University of Alabama Governor George Wallace stood in the schoolhouse door to block Black students from enrolling. Football integration followed years later — and changed the program forever." No financial penalty. This is a moment of education.

[Theme: Integration / Racial Context / Civil Rights]

"PAY SCHOOL TAXES — \$100K OR 10% OF ASSETS, WHICHEVER IS LESS"

Calculate your total assets and pay the lesser amount to the Commissioner.

[Theme: General gameplay — tax mechanic]

"YOUR PROGRAM GOES ON A BOWL STREAK — COLLECT \$300K"

Six consecutive bowl appearances bring in TV revenue and recruiting momentum. Collect \$300K from the Commissioner.

[Theme: Billion-Dollar Industry]

"ESCAPE NCAA INVESTIGATION"

Keep this card. Use it to leave NCAA Probation free, or sell it to another player at any agreed price.

[Theme: Current Issues — NCAA compliance]

"TRANSFER PORTAL BRINGS YOU A 5-STAR QUARTERBACK — COLLECT \$200K"

A star transfer elevates your program's profile and ticket sales. Collect \$200K from the Commissioner.

[Theme: Current Issues — Transfer Portal]

"THE CIVIL RIGHTS ACT OF 1964 — INTEGRATE YOUR PROGRAM"

If you own any program in the Pink (Depression/Wartime) or Orange (Integration Era) group, collect \$250K as your program modernizes. If you own no programs in these groups, collect \$50K. This card reflects how integration ultimately strengthened programs that embraced it.

[Theme: Integration / Civil Rights Movement]

SPECIAL SPACES

NIL SIGNING DAY (Free Parking)

You simply rest here until your next turn. No penalty or reward. You may still collect revenue from opponents who land on your properties.

★ HISTORICAL NOTE

The NIL era began July 1, 2021, when the NCAA finally allowed college athletes to profit from their Name, Image, and Likeness. Within months, top quarterbacks were earning millions from endorsements. NIL collectives — groups of boosters pooling money to pay athletes — emerged at every major program. The old model of 'amateurism' was effectively over.

PROGRAM EXPENSES (Income Tax)

Pay **\$200K** or **10% of your total assets** (programs, buildings, cash, and unmortgaged program values), whichever is lower. You must **DECIDE** which you are paying **before** you calculate.

STADIUM RENOVATION TAX (Luxury Tax)

Pay **\$100K** to the Commissioner.

TRADING, MORTGAGING & BANKRUPTCY

TRADING AND SELLING

You may trade or sell any **undeveloped** Program, Bowl Game, or TV Contract to another player at any privately agreed price. Negotiations are encouraged — and historically accurate.

Restrictions:

- You may NOT sell a program if any Recruiting Classes or Stadium Expansions are built on ANY program in that color group. You must first sell all buildings back to the Commissioner at half price.
- Players may not loan or borrow money from each other. Money may only be borrowed by mortgaging a property to the Commissioner.

Selling Buildings: Recruiting Classes and Stadium Expansions are sold to the Commissioner **ONLY** at **HALF** their original purchase price. Buildings must be sold evenly across the group.

MORTGAGING PROGRAMS

If you need to raise cash, you may mortgage any of your programs to the Commissioner.

To mortgage a program:

- First sell all buildings on that color group back to the Commissioner.
- Turn the Program Deed **face-down**.
- Collect the mortgage value from the Commissioner (half the purchase price).

You retain ownership of mortgaged programs. No other player can claim them. You cannot collect revenue on a mortgaged program, but you CAN collect revenue on other programs within the same color group (unless those are also mortgaged).

To lift a mortgage: Pay the Commissioner the mortgage value plus **10% interest**.

Selling mortgaged programs: You may sell mortgaged programs to other players at any agreed price. The buyer must immediately pay 10% interest to the Commissioner, then may either pay off the mortgage in full or retain it.

BANKRUPTCY

If you owe more money than you can raise through all available means — cash, selling buildings, and mortgaging properties — you are declared **BANKRUPT** and eliminated from the game.

If you go bankrupt to the Commissioner (Bank):

- The Commissioner takes all your cash and Program Deeds.
- All your programs are auctioned immediately to the remaining players.
- Return any 'Escape NCAA Investigation' cards to the bottom of the deck.

If you go bankrupt to another player:

- That player receives all your cash, Program Deeds, and 'Escape NCAA Investigation' cards.
- Your buildings are sold to the Commissioner at half price, and the proceeds go to the player who bankrupted you.
- If you have mortgaged programs, the receiving player must immediately pay 10% interest and then choose to lift the mortgage or retain it.

★ HISTORICAL NOTE

The threat of 'bankruptcy' mirrors real economic pressures facing college athletic departments. Over half of all Division I programs operate at a deficit, kept afloat only by revenue from football and basketball. Schools in smaller conferences earn fractions of what SEC schools earn, creating an ever-widening gap in competitive resources.

WINNING THE GAME

The last Commissioner standing — the only player who has not gone bankrupt — is declared the winner.

OPTIONAL TIME LIMIT RULE (recommended for classroom play): Before starting, agree on a time limit (suggested: 45–60 minutes). When time expires, all players add up: cash in hand + current value of all owned programs (at printed board price) + mortgaged programs at half their printed board price + Recruiting Classes at their purchase price + Stadium Expansions at purchase price. The player with the highest total is the winner.

SHORT GAME RULES

For a faster game (recommended: 30–40 minutes):

- **SETUP:** The Commissioner shuffles all Program Deed cards and deals 2 to each player. Each player immediately pays the Commissioner the printed price for each program they receive. Play begins as in the standard game.
- **BUILDING:** Only **3 Recruiting Classes** (instead of 4) are required on each program before building a Stadium Expansion. Stadium Expansion revenue remains the same.
- **END OF GAME:** When the FIRST player goes bankrupt, the game ends immediately. All remaining players calculate their total wealth (cash + program values + buildings). The richest player wins.

EDUCATIONAL DISCUSSION GUIDE

This game is designed not only for entertainment but for education. After playing, consider discussing the following questions with your fellow players:

1. Why did college football take root so deeply in the American South, more than in any other region of the country?
2. What does it mean that racial integration of Southern football programs came so late — and so publicly? What does that tell us about the relationship between sports and social change?
3. The game models college football as a 'billion-dollar industry.' But for most of its history, the athletes generating that revenue were unpaid. How do you think about the ethics of that arrangement? How does the NIL era change it?
4. Conference realignment has shattered geographic traditions in favor of television dollars. Is this progress, or does it destroy something valuable?
5. If you were advising a Fortune 100 firm on how to enter the college football industry, what piece of this game's history would you most want them to understand before they invested?

GLOSSARY FOR INTERNATIONAL PLAYERS

ATHLETIC DEPARTMENT	The university division that oversees all sports programs. At major schools, football revenue subsidizes every other sport.
BOWL GAME	A postseason game held at a neutral site, originally tied to tourist events in warm-weather cities. There are now over 40 bowl games annually.
CFP (College Football Playoff)	The current postseason championship format, expanded to 12 teams in 2024. Distributes over \$500M to conferences.
CONFERENCE	A group of universities that compete against each other regularly and share revenue from media contracts. The SEC is the most powerful.
HBCU (Historically Black College or University)	Universities founded to serve Black students during and after segregation. HBCUs maintained their own football tradition, producing legendary coaches and players.
HEAD COACH	The lead coach of a football program. Top SEC coaches earn \$8–10M per year — often more than any other employee at the university.
INTEGRATION	The process by which Black athletes were admitted to and allowed to play for previously all-white Southern programs. This process was slow, contested, and not complete until the early 1970s.
NIL (Name, Image, and Likeness)	The right of college athletes (since 2021) to earn money from endorsements, appearances, and social media.

RECRUITING

The process of identifying, pursuing, and signing high school athletes to join a college program. Violations of recruiting rules are among the most common NCAA infractions.

REVENUE SHARE

The emerging model (2025) in which universities directly pay athletes a portion of program revenue — a dramatic departure from the traditional 'amateur' model.

SEC (Southeastern Conference)

The most dominant and most valuable conference in college football. Members include Alabama, Georgia, LSU, Tennessee, Florida, and others. Annual revenue exceeds \$800 million.

TRANSFER PORTAL

The NCAA database through which players announce their intent to transfer to a new school. Since 2021, players can transfer freely and play immediately. Over 1,500 players enter the portal each year.

CREDITS & ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

FROM THE FIELD TO THE FORTUNE was created as part of **HIS 317L: History of College Football, Spring 2026**, under the instruction of Dr. Moore.

Game design inspired by the classic MONOPOLY board game structure.

All historical events, figures, dates, and statistics referenced in this rulebook are grounded in documented American sports history. This game is intended as an educational tool to help international audiences understand the cultural, racial, economic, and social dimensions of college football in the American South.

*"Football is to the South what religion is to the soul —
it is not what we do on Saturday. It is who we are."*

END OF RULEBOOK

From The Field To The Fortune